

Surface 3

'Tis more than a scratch on the surface. Finally, Microsoft sort of gets it.

Microsoft has spent the last three years much like Porsche has spent the last 50. By reinventing cars that have their centre of gravity at the back (where the engine is) over each subsequent generation of the 911, they've struck gold. Microsoft applied the same formula to the Surface Pro and in its third iteration, they have a winner in their hands. With the same learnings, Microsoft's latest offering is the Surface 3, a tablet with a proper copy of Windows 8.1, a Cherry Trail Atom processor from Intel and the ability to run any x86 based program. While the Surface RT and its successor, the Surface 2 were stuck with apps on the Windows Store and were basically tablets, the Surface 3 however – once docked that is – becomes a low-cost full-fledged computer with impeccable build quality that you can take anywhere.

While the Surface 3 may seem, at first glance, like the Surface 2, it's actually thinner and lighter than the predecessor. You'll still find the same matte aluminium finish flushed all along its screen's surface, which can be paired with an optional keyboard in two shades of blue and shade of red and silver each. The full HD screen is also a little bigger than before and resides in a



more portrait-friendly 3:2 ratio. The Surface 3 also comes with an optional stylus featuring the same technology from the Surface Pro 3. While it's not an iPad killer, and was never meant to be one, it still puts up a pretty decent fight in the tablet-laptop convergence space. Seems like a winning formula to us.

SPECIFICATIONS

Screen: 10.8-inch multi-touch full HD Display | **RAM:** Up to 4GB | **Storage:** Up to 128 GB SSD | **Processor:** 1.6 GHz quad-core Atom processor | **Battery:** Up to 10 hours
Price: \$499 (₹31,211)



Hisense Chromebook

In an era where laptops running glorified web browsers can cost \$1,000 *coughChromebookPixelcough*, it's both refreshing and unnerving to see one that's at the bottom end of the price scale and treads the budget tablet segment. But, the Hisense Chromebook is no dud. But it's no winner either. It plays safe, does what's expected. Looks better than expected and goes back home. If you're looking for a laptop and you're strapped for cash, this is your pick and you won't be disappointed. It's got pretty decent specs what with a 1.8 GHz quad core Rockchip processor and 2 GB RAM. It also offers two USB ports and a proper SD card reader. The only thing about this Chromebook that truly lives up to the price tag though is the screen.

SPECIFICATIONS

Screen: 11-inch 1366x786 pixels, 135 ppi | **Processor:** 1.8 GHz quad core RockchipRK 3288 | **Memory:** 2GB DDR3 | **Storage:** 16 GB eMMC SSD | **Battery:** Up to 8.5 hours
Price: \$149 (₹9,319)